

nt Center

tional Student

w My Messages

om: School

roll for your semester asap before spaces are filled up
art enrolling at "Academics: Enrollment".

om: International Student
o: Mom

on't worry mom, I'm doing fine, I'll help pay tuitio...

H for Help

The International Student Portal: A Theatrical Critique

This simulated San José State University Student Portal immerses users in the frustrating systemic barriers often faced by international students, subtly revealed through its design.

Project Proposal & Elevator Pitch

Elevator pitch

My project is a fake SJSU Student Portal that lets you click around like the real Student Center but quietly drags you through the experience of being an international student. The interface looks official and helpful at first, but the sounds, waits, and rejection scenes slowly reveal how the system blocks you from money, jobs, and even class enrollment. The type of **Interface** is **Simulation**.

Authentic Interface

Meticulous replication of a real university portal creates a tangible, believable experience for the user.

Emotional Soundscapes

Strategic sound design evokes confusion and anxiety, enhancing empathy for the international student journey.

Visual Language Mashup

Official aesthetics meet sarcastic content, exposing systemic absurdities through contrasting visual cues.

Exaggerated Realism

Key administrative hurdles are magnified to highlight student anxieties and communication breakdowns.

Proposal: How my project uses the interface ideas

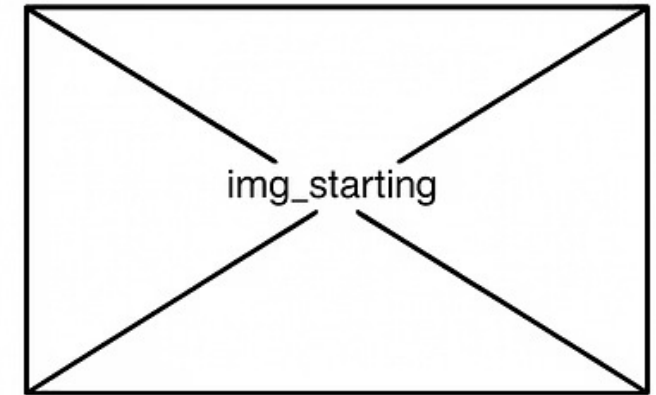
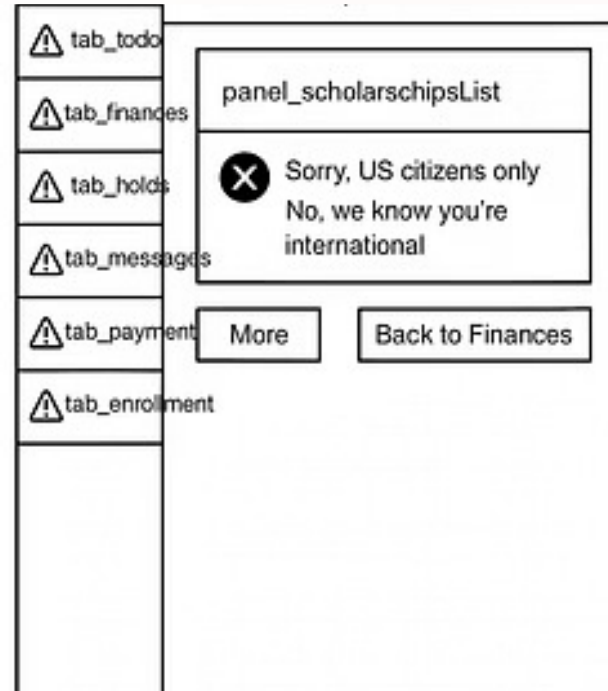
I focus mainly on theatrification and simulation. The whole portal is a simulation of the real SJSU Student Center. There are tabs for To Do, Finances, Holds, Messages, Payment, and Enrollment, plus extra scenes for Scholarships, Rejected, and Job Rejected. You do not actually pay or enroll, but you feel the same logic and the same walls.

At the same time the portal behaves like a performer. Entrance, click, and error sounds mark every change of mood. The error sound is extra loud in the rejection scenes, so the system almost feels like it is talking back. The long timer in Enrollment, where you have to wait before you can “magically” sign up for classes, is a piece of theatre that exaggerates how slow and stressful enrollment feels for students.

The interface is also a visual language mashup. I copy the layout and colors of a serious university system, with a blue header, left sidebar tabs, and grey content boxes, but I fill those boxes with sarcastic text about scholarships that are “US citizens only” and jobs that you cannot really get. It is half real interface, half commentary.

Wireframe Sketches

These wireframe sketches serve as the structural blueprints of the portal design, illustrating the layout and user flow before detailed visual design was applied.

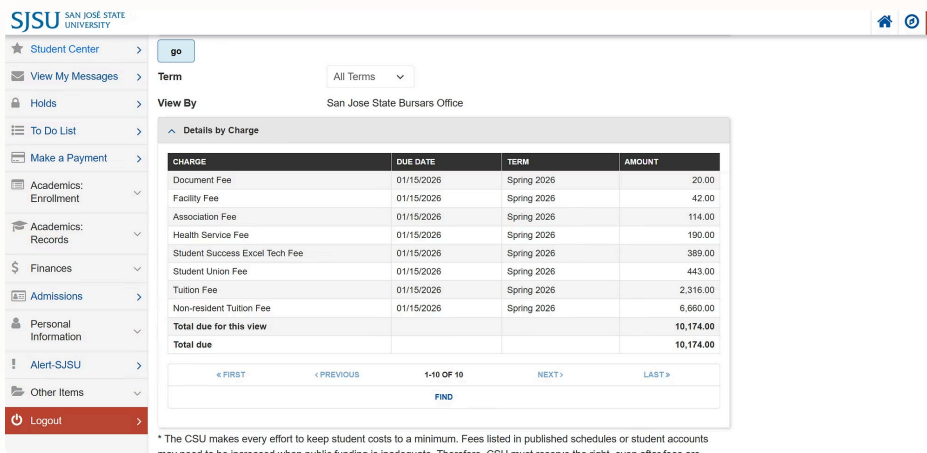
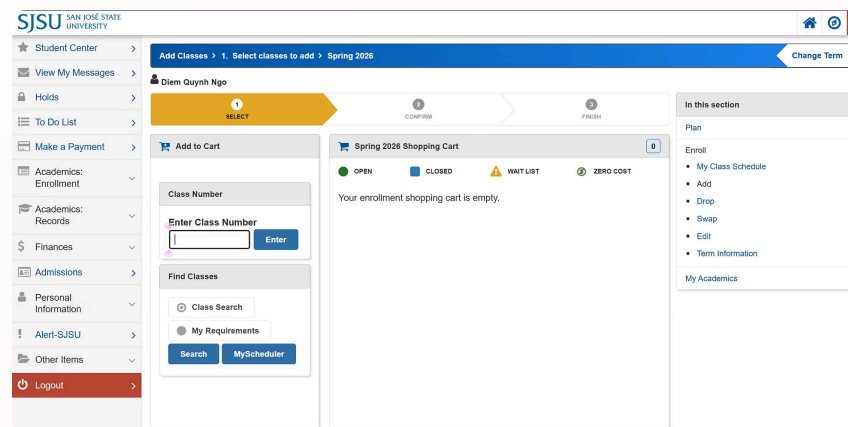
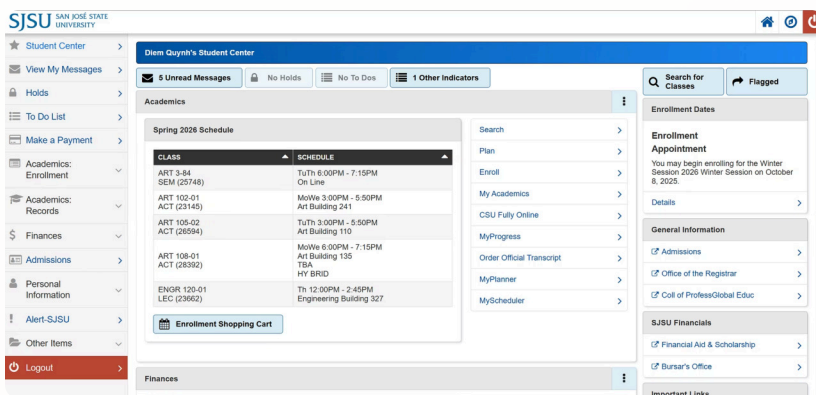


Click anywhere or press SPACE to continue

Press H for Help

Mood Board

This mood board visually defines the aesthetic and emotional landscape of the International Student Portal, using specific elements to convey its intended message.



Visual and textural details include:

- Color palette: dark blue, grey, white, with red and gold accents
- Visual style: flat rectangles, simple icons, office-style interface
- Emotional tone: stress, waiting, rejection
- Audio elements: loud error sounds contrasting with calm entry sounds